

CASE ID: 202508710368

EPISODE NAME: China Sanctions Lithuanian Banks

2025/08/13 - Ongoing

Sender: China (710)

Target: Lithuania (368)

Issue: Retaliation (16)

Final Outcome: Ongoing

Summary:

On 2025/08/13, China sanctioned Lithuanian banks UAB Urbo Bankas and Mano Bankas AB.¹ The measures were in response to European Union sanctions on financial institutions supporting the Russian war effort in Ukraine, imposed 2025/08/09, that included Chinese banks Heihe Rural Commercial Bank and Heilongjiang Suifenhe Rural Commercial Bank.² The episode is ongoing.

Narrative:

On 2025/08/09, the EU sanctioned several institutions financing Russia's invasion of Ukraine.³ Two of these corporations, Heihe Rural Commercial Bank and Heilongjiang Suifenhe Rural Commercial Bank, were Chinese.⁴ These sanctions primarily targeted Russia.

In response, on 2025/08/13, China banned Lithuanian banks UAB Urbo Bankas and Mano Bankas AB from working with organizations and individuals in China.⁵ China's retaliatory sanctions are not expected to affect the Lithuania bank's services because neither institution operates in China.⁶

¹ Associated Press. "China Imposes Sanctions on Two Lithuanian Banks in Retaliation for EU Penalties on Chinese Lenders." AP News, 13 Aug. 2025, apnews.com/article/eu-sanctions-china-lithuanian-banks-russia-war-cc564700a742eca388b4d6497f9a772c.

² Ni, Vincent. "China Targets Two EU Banks in Retaliation for Bloc's Russia Sanctions Package." Reuters, 13 Aug. 2025, www.reuters.com/world/china/china-targets-two-eu-banks-retaliating-blocs-russia-sanctions-package-2025-08-13/.

³ Associated Press. "China Imposes Sanctions on Two Lithuanian Banks in Retaliation for EU Penalties on Chinese Lenders." AP News, 13 Aug. 2025, apnews.com/article/eu-sanctions-china-lithuanian-banks-russia-war-cc564700a742eca388b4d6497f9a772c.

⁴ Ni, Vincent. "China Targets Two EU Banks in Retaliation for Bloc's Russia Sanctions Package." Reuters, 13 Aug. 2025, www.reuters.com/world/china/china-targets-two-eu-banks-retaliating-blocs-russia-sanctions-package-2025-08-13/.

⁵ Ni, Vincent. "China Targets Two EU Banks in Retaliation for Bloc's Russia Sanctions Package." Reuters, 13 Aug. 2025, www.reuters.com/world/china/china-targets-two-eu-banks-retaliating-blocs-russia-sanctions-package-2025-08-13/.

⁶ Euronews. "EU Demands Beijing Revoke 'Unjustified' Sanctions on Lithuanian Banks." Euronews, 15 Aug. 2025, <https://www.euronews.com/business/2025/08/14/eu-urges-china-to-drop-sanctions-on-lithuanian-banks-amid->

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